

control the interactions with Miko 2 app and parental dashboard. They can also have a video call with their child. “Miko 2 is compliant with all child safety standards globally,” adds Vaswani.

Talking about government support, he says, “The government has supported us in different ways and encouraged Miko 2 to take the next step in the education sector. We are registered as

a startup under Ministry of Commerce, and avail the benefits for the same.”

The robot comes in three colours, namely, martian red, goblin green and pixie blue. It is available online as well as in different offline stores across India for a price of ₹ 24,999. The company hopes to develop solutions across verticals like childcare, elderly care and others, globally.

Discussing future plans, Vaswani

says, “Our clients loved playing with the advanced version of the robot, Miko 2. Based on the feedback and suggestions we receive from them time and again, we keep updating the product with new, advanced features and keep on evolving the entire user experience. We have a pipeline of products for the next five years, which is currently under development.”

—Ayushee Sharma

## 5 AN AUTOMATED BURGER-MAKING ROBOT

**R**obots entering the field of food production is inevitable to save time and space, as well as improve safety and cleanliness. Creator is the first to build a 4.27-metre (14-feet)-long machine that makes the burger from start to finish, in about five minutes without any human assistance. The entire process is visible through a glass display case, starring every ingredient that goes into or on the burger. An app that lets people customise and order the exact ratios of ingredients unlocks many permutations for taste.

This is how it works. Once an order is placed based on a particular burger style through a human concierge with a tablet, a compressed air tube pushes a baked-that-day bun into an elevator on the right. It is sawed in half by a vibrating knife before being toasted and buttered as it is lowered to the conveyor belt. Sauces and spices are automatically squirted onto the bun, while pickles, tomatoes, onions and blocks of cheese get slices shaved off just a second before they are dropped on top. Strands of meat hang vertically and are lightly pressed together so that instead of requiring harsh chewing they almost melt in the mouth.

Creator can customise burgers with fifteen sauces and twelve seasonings. It uses sensors to determine the ideal cook level and ingredients of the burger. The robot is also capable of being customisable in terms of ingredient requests, such as dispensing sauce by the millilitre, or serving



low-sodium options by seasoning only the bottom patty with salt so its taste is more prominent. Using customisations requested by both staff and customers, it optimises the menu, and the machines are capable of constant iterations.

Alex Vardakostas, co-founder and chief executive officer, Creator, says, “A lot comes from savings on labour and kitchen space afforded by a robot cook. The full Creator robot uses 350 sensors, 50 actuators and 20 computers to ensure every sauce is dispensed down to the millilitre, and every spice down to the gram.”

Due to the robot cooking, human staff are only needed to restock the machine, and take and deliver orders. Humans are part of the process; they make sauces and prep the items that go into the machine. When there is an issue with the machine—something needs to be refilled or a burger has lost its way in the process—humans

in the room receive an alert on their Apple Watch, letting them know exactly where the problem is occurring. Fries, side salads and other items on the menu are prepared by humans in the back.

Steve Frehn, co-founder and chief operating officer, says, “The complex nature of the machines might naturally open up unique career opportunities to staff members who work alongside or with the equipment.” He believes that skills gained from working with these robots can potentially be transferred to other industries and open up more advanced opportunities within the company.

This particular machine was designed to minimise repetitive and often unhealthy tasks like standing over a smoky grill for hours at a time. Air in the electric griddles that cooks the burgers is cleaned via multiple filters to improve its quality. **EFY**

—Deepshikha Shukla